IRB2021-00062_MOD006
Approved: 9/17/2025
Stony Brook University Institutional Review Board

RESEARCH CONSENT FORM

Project Title: Adaptive Communication in Text and Spoken Dialogue
Principal Investigator: Professor Susan Brennan
Co-Investigators: Graduate Students Amie Paige, James May, Mackenzie Johnson, Weiling Li
Department: Psychology

Study Condition: _____

KEY INFORMATION

(1) This form is being used to seek your consent for a research study. Being in the study is voluntary; it is up to you.
(2) You must be a native English speaker and at least 18 years old to participate.
(3) This research is about how people communicate using speech or text. The experiment is expected to take one hour or less, unless you signed up for a longer time slot.
(4) Study procedures will include one or more of the following, to be done either alone or with a partner (depending on the experimental session you signed up for):
   - You may be asked to read text and make judgments, speak aloud (for instance, respond to cues, give instructions, tell stories, read text aloud, make judgments or choices, solve problems, or respond to questions).
   - You may be asked to listen to speech or read text silently and make judgments.
   - You may be asked to fill out one or more questionnaires (for instance, about general knowledge or about your language background).
   - Your responses, such as key presses and choices, and what you say may be recorded (audiotaped or videotaped) for data analysis later.
   - You may be asked to converse with another person (either via chat or via Zoom with your webcam on) or with a chatbot. Your session will be recorded.
   - If you sign a separate release, the audio or video recording may be shared with other language researchers later or used as stimuli in another study (other subjects may listen to what you say or may see you speaking).
   - We will debrief you about the study hypotheses after the experimental session(s) so that you will learn more about the research. (You will not get to see your own data.)
(5) There are no foreseeable risks associated with your participation in this study beyond those in everyday life.
(6) There is no direct benefit to you as a result of you being in this study.
(7) As this is not a treatment study, the alternative to being in this study is to not participate.

You are being asked to be a volunteer in a research study.

PURPOSE

The purpose of this study is: to learn more about the psychology of communication in adults.

You must be a native speaker of English and 18 years old or older to participate. You must have normal (or corrected-to-normal) hearing and vision.

PROCEDURES

If you decide to be in this study, your part will involve doing one or more of the following (as specified in the online advertisement for this task):

- Reading text
- Making judgments
- Filling out one or more questionnaires (for instance, about general knowledge and/or about your language background)
- Speaking aloud, listening to speech, or conversing with another person (either via chat or via Zoom with your webcam on), or interacting via text with a chatbot. Your session will be recorded.

Your responses, such as what you say, your key presses, choices, and responses, will be recorded for data analysis later. If you sign a separate release, any audio or video recordings may be shared with other language researchers later or used as stimuli in another study (other subjects may listen to what you say or may see you speaking). Signing the release form is optional. Your name will not be included in any shared recordings.

INFORMATION ABOUT DATA

Identifiers might be removed from your identifiable private information **and** after such removal, the information may be used for future research studies or distributed to another investigator for future research studies without additional informed consent from you or your legally authorized representative.

However, you may sign the accompanying release form to allow us to distribute any videos (with your face still visible) and audio recordings created during this study to future researchers or databases of recorded spoken language. You do not need to sign the release form in order to participate in this study.

RISKS / DISCOMFORTS: There are no foreseeable risks or discomforts associated with participating in this study, beyond those of everyday life.

BENEFITS: There is no direct benefit to you as a result of being in this study. By participating, you will contribute to basic research in human communication.

CREDIT OR PAYMENT TO YOU: You will receive $12 per hour of participation (pro-rated and rounded up in 15 min increments), as was specified when you signed up for this online task. This payment will be awarded to your account shortly after you complete the study (we will first determine that you are not a bot nor responding at random or failing to follow the instructions).

CONFIDENTIALITY

Your participant ID and IP address will not be associated with the data or included in any reports, presentations, or public releases of the data. Your participant ID and IP address will be removed from the data when data collection for this study is complete; your data will be identified with a code that cannot be linked back to your information. We will not ask you for any personally identifying information. Any text generated during this experiment may be shared with other language researchers or be used to train a language model. Note that if you have signed up to participate in a Zoom session with another participant, you will see each other while you are conversing. We will ask each of you to keep your partner's

participation confidential; i if you have signed the release form for data sharing, then your names will be blocked out before the data are shared.

After you participate, any audio or video recordings will be transcribed and stored indefinitely without any information about your identity. If you sign a separate release, your audio or video may be shared with other language researchers or used as stimuli in another study (others may listen to what you say or may see you speaking). Signing the release form is optional. Your name will not be included in any data shared with other researchers outside the study team. Note that if you have signed up to participate in a Zoom session with another participant, you will see and hear each other while you are conversing. We will ask each of you to keep your partner's participation confidential, and will ensure that your names do not appear on any sharable Zoom recording.

We want to make sure that this study is being done correctly and that your rights and welfare are being protected. For this reason, we will share the data we get from you in this study with the study team, the sponsor of the study (and those who work for them), Stony Brook University's Institutional Review Board, applicable Institutional officials, and certain federal offices, including the Office for Human Research Protections (OHRP), and, where applicable, the Food and Drug Administration (FDA). However, if you tell us you are going to hurt yourself, hurt someone else, or if we believe the safety of a child is at risk, we will have to report this.

In a lawsuit, a judge can make us give them the information we collected about you.

COSTS TO YOU: There are no costs to you for participating in this study.

ALTERNATIVES: Your alternative to being in this study is simply to not participate.

YOUR RIGHTS AS A RESEARCH SUBJECT

- Your participation in this study is voluntary. You do not have to be in this study if you don't want to be.
- You have the right to change your mind and leave the study at any time without giving any reason, and without penalty.
- Any new information that may make you change your mind about being in this study will be given to you.
- You will get a copy of this consent form to keep.
- You do not lose any of your legal rights by signing this consent form or by participating in this study for online subjects.

QUESTIONS ABOUT THE STUDY OR YOUR RIGHTS AS A RESEARCH SUBJECT

- If you have any questions, concerns, or complaints about the study, you may contact Dr. Susan Brennan at susan.brennan@stonybrook.edu.
- If you have any questions about your rights as a research subject or if you would like to obtain information or offer input, you may contact the Stony Brook University Research Subject Advocate, Ms. Lu-Ann Kozlowski, BSN, RN, (631) 632-9036, OR by e-mail, luann.kozlowski@stonybrook.edu.
- Visit Stony Brook University's Community Outreach page, https://www.stonybrook.edu/research-community-outreach/ for more information about participating in research, frequently asked questions, and an opportunity to provide feedback, comments, or ask questions related to your experience as a research subject.

Completing the following computer-based tasks means that you have read this consent document, feel that you understand it, and would like to participate in this research study.